

Decent Coaching Classes

IX CBSE

Academic Conquest - I

Subject: English (Kaveri)
Chapters: Winds of Change; Canvas of Soil

Time: 1 Hour
Maximum Marks: 30

General Instructions:

- (i) This paper is divided into three sections: A, B and C.
- (ii) All questions are compulsory unless internal choice is indicated.
- (iii) Marks are indicated against each question.
- (iv) Write neat and legible answers.

SECTION A — Reading Comprehension

8 Marks

Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow:

Long before electric fans lit up Indian homes, the humble hand fan kept families cool through the summer months. Every region of the country shaped its own version of this everyday object, choosing whatever material was locally at hand — grass, palm leaf, cloth, or bamboo — and decorating it according to local taste. What began purely as a practical tool for stirring air gradually became a canvas for embroidery, mirror-work, and painted motifs. Craftspersons passed the skill down through families, and over generations a simple cooling device turned into an object that carried the identity of its place of origin. Today, as machines have taken over the task of cooling homes, many of these hand-crafted fans survive mainly as decorative pieces or souvenirs, prized more for their artistry than their original purpose.

- (a) According to the passage, why did different regions develop different styles of hand fans? (1)
- (b) Pick out one word from the passage that means 'skilled workers who make things by hand'. (1)
- (c) State whether the following is True or False: The passage suggests hand fans are now used mainly for cooling homes. (1)
- (d) What does the phrase 'a canvas for embroidery, mirror-work, and painted motifs' suggest about the purpose of hand fans over time? (2)
- (e) Based on the passage and the chapter 'Winds of Change', give one reason why the culture of pankha-making is at risk of disappearing. (2)
- (f) Suggest one way, based on the chapter, in which this traditional craft can be preserved. (1)

SECTION B — Vocabulary and Grammar

10 Marks

2. Match the words in Column 1 with their meanings in Column 2:

[4]

Column 1	Column 2
1. indigenous	(i) elaborate / detailed
2. innovative	(ii) local — from where it originated
3. industrious	(iii) new and original in approach
4. intricate	(iv) hardworking
5. invoked	(v) actions to improve a situation
6. initiatives	(vi) brought out

3. Fill in the blanks with the correct present perfect form of the verbs given in brackets:

[3]

- (a) Artisans in many states _____ (preserve) the tradition of hand-fan making despite changing times.
- (b) Over the years, pankha designs _____ (evolve) to include new materials and patterns.
- (c) The government _____ (launch) several initiatives to promote traditional handicrafts.

4. Choose the correct word collocation to complete each sentence:

[3]

- (a) *Students have to (take / give) the practical exam next week.*
(b) *The shopkeeper asked us to (take / have) a look at the new collection of fans.*
(c) *I would like to (tone up / improve) my vocabulary before the exam.*

SECTION C — Literature	12 Marks
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5. Answer any THREE of the following questions in 30–40 words each: [6 (3×2)]
- (a) Name any two states mentioned in 'Winds of Change' along with the material used for their traditional hand fans.
 - (b) Why are pankhas described as reflecting the 'cultural core' of the region that crafts them?
 - (c) In the poem 'Canvas of Soil', what does the poet compare a garden plot to, and why is this comparison apt?
 - (d) How did pankhas change from being personal-use items to commercial products, as explained in the chapter?
6. Answer any TWO of the following questions in 40–50 words each: [6 (2×3)]
- (a) Explain how the poem 'Canvas of Soil' can be read as an allegory. What larger idea might the garden symbolise?
 - (b) Describe any two distinct varieties of hand fans mentioned in the chapter, along with the states they belong to and their special features.
 - (c) 'Initiatives such as pankha-making workshops help spread awareness about this craft.' Explain how such initiatives could benefit artisans.

— *End of Paper* —

ANSWER KEY

Section A — Reading Comprehension (8 Marks)

- (a) Because each region used whatever material was locally available and decorated fans according to local taste — so styles naturally differed from place to place.
- (b) Craftspersons
- (c) False — the passage states they now survive mainly as decorative pieces/souvenirs, not for cooling homes.
- (d) It suggests that hand fans moved beyond their practical, functional purpose (cooling) and became objects of artistic expression and decoration.
- (e) Any valid reason from the chapter, e.g., the advent of technology and modern innovations (like electric fans) has reduced the everyday need for hand fans, putting the traditional craft at risk of losing its presence among Indians.
- (f) Any valid suggestion, e.g., organising pankha-making workshops and handicraft exhibitions to celebrate the craft and spread awareness about its beauty and importance.

Section B — Vocabulary and Grammar (10 Marks)

2. 1–(ii), 2–(iii), 3–(iv), 4–(i), 5–(vi), 6–(v)
3. (a) have preserved (b) have evolved (c) has launched
4. (a) take (b) take (c) improve

Section C — Literature (12 Marks)

5. (a) Any two, e.g., Assam (locally available cane/grass), Kerala (palm leaf), Uttar Pradesh (Moonj grass / Phadh fans with gold and silver zari).
- (b) Because the structure, material, and design of each fan reflect the specific materials, skills, and traditions unique to the region that produces it — making each pankha a marker of local identity.
- (c) The poet compares each garden plot to a wide canvas, since both are spaces where something is deliberately created and shaped — the gardener 'paints' with plants just as an artist paints with colours, making art and life meet in the same space.
- (d) Once made purely for personal use, pankhas gradually became significant cultural goods traded across regions; with rising popularity and demand for different crafted versions, the handicraft transformed into a commercial business providing livelihood to artisans.
6. (a) The garden in the poem can be read on two levels: literally, as a description of a garden being tended and coming into bloom; and allegorically, as a symbol for life's journey and growth (its changing seasons mirroring stages of life) or for harmony and diversity (different coloured flowers coexisting beautifully, like different people or ideas).
- (b) Any two, e.g., the appliqué hand fan of Rajasthan (fabric pieces in different shapes sewn together with ornamental needlework) and the beads hand fan of Gujarat (covered with colourful beads, silver handle, used for wall decoration).
- (c) Such initiatives give contemporary pankha makers a platform to showcase their craft, help the art form regain popularity, spread awareness about its cultural value, and create a sustainable livelihood for artisans by boosting demand for their work.